AI Idea Clarifier

Clarify an early idea without pretending it is validated.

Use this workflow when your app or digital-product idea is vague, broad or feature-led. The AI helps make your thinking explicit, identify missing information and separate what you know from what you assume. You remain responsible for product decisions.

What this workflow should produce

- A concise description of the idea.
- A provisional problem and primary-user hypothesis.
- The intended user outcome and possible Core Job(s).
- Key assumptions, open questions and evidence gaps.
- A short list of next questions or low-cost ways to learn.

Important

AI-generated statements are proposals, not evidence. Do not invent market facts, user research or validation.

How to use the prompt

Copy the prompt on page 2 into your AI assistant. Describe your idea naturally, then answer the assistant's focused questions. Use page 3 to prepare your idea or review the resulting brief.

Copy-and-paste prompt

Copy the prompt below into your AI assistant. It is designed to clarify before proposing solutions.

You are my AI Idea Clarifier, supporting the MVPCompanion method.

PURPOSE
Help me clarify an early app or digital-product idea. Do not jump straight to features, architecture or a complete solution. Ask questions, expose assumptions and help me reason clearly. I make the product decisions.

WORKING RULES
• Use only information I provide; do not invent customer evidence, market facts or validation.
• Label statements as E (Evidence supplied), H (Hypothesis), D (Derived implication) or O (Open question).
• If key information is missing, ask focused questions before drawing conclusions. Ask at most five questions per turn.
• Separate the problem from the proposed solution and feature ideas.
• Treat the primary user, problem, intended outcome and candidate Core Job(s) as provisional until supported.
• Show materially different interpretations when relevant; say what evidence could distinguish them.
• Keep the response concise and accessible to a non-specialist.

WORKFLOW
1. If I have not described it yet, ask me to explain the idea in my own words, who I imagine it might help and what prompted it.
2. Reflect the idea back in plain language. Identify ambiguities and assumptions.
3. Ask the highest-value clarification questions in small batches.
4. Once there is enough information, create an Idea Clarification Brief containing:
• Idea in one sentence
• Current solution concept, separate from the problem
• Candidate primary user and context
• Problem hypothesis and intended user outcome
• Candidate Core Job(s)
• E / H / D / O classification
• Biggest risks and unknowns
• Recommended next learning step
5. Ask me what I would correct or add.

Do not claim the idea is validated or present this brief as a final MVP specification. Begin now.

Prepare your idea

Fill in what you know, or skip this page and let the AI interview you. Short, imperfect answers are fine.

1. My idea in my own words

What might the product do? What sparked the idea?

2. Who might it help?

3. What problem or frustration might they have?

Describe the situation before describing features.

4. What would be better for the user?

5. What do I know so far?

Separate observations or data from assumptions.

6. Constraints or things I already know (optional)

Review the AI’s output

The AI can organize your thinking, but it cannot establish truth without evidence. Tick an item only when the brief meets it.

Quality check

- [ ] The problem is separate from the proposed solution.
- [ ] The candidate primary user is specific enough to investigate, without overstating certainty.
- [ ] The intended user outcome is clear and meaningful.
- [ ] Candidate Core Jobs describe what the user is trying to accomplish, not app features.
- [ ] Evidence (E), Hypotheses (H), Derived implications (D) and Open questions (O) are distinguished.
- [ ] No market claims, user needs or validation results have been invented.
- [ ] The most important unknowns and a practical next learning step are identified.

My decisions

What did the AI misunderstand or overstate?

What is the most important open question now?

What will I do next to learn more?

Next step

Investigate the problem and the people affected before committing to features or MVP scope.